

LM79XX Series 3-Terminal Negative Regulators

Check for Samples: [LM7905](#), [LM7912](#), [LM7915](#)

FEATURES

- Thermal, Short Circuit and Safe Area Protection
- High Ripple Rejection
- 1.5A Output Current
- 4% Tolerance on Preset Output Voltage

DESCRIPTION

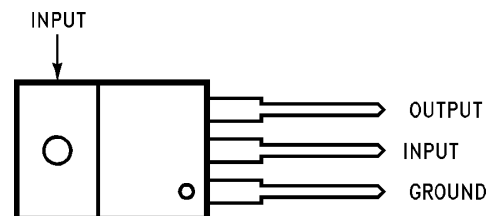
The LM79XX series of 3-terminal regulators is available with fixed output voltages of $-5V$, $-12V$, and $-15V$. These devices need only one external component—a compensation capacitor at the output. The LM79XX series is packaged in the TO-220 power package and is capable of supplying 1.5A of output current.

These regulators employ internal current limiting safe area protection and thermal shutdown for protection against virtually all overload conditions.

Low ground pin current of the LM79XX series allows output voltage to be easily boosted above the preset value with a resistor divider. The low quiescent current drain of these devices with a specified maximum change with line and load ensures good regulation in the voltage boosted mode.

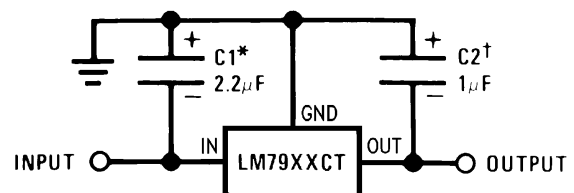
For applications requiring other voltages, see LM137 datasheet.

Connection Diagram



**Figure 1. TO-220 Package
Front View
See Package Number NDE0003B**

Typical Applications



*Required if regulator is separated from filter capacitor by more than 3". For value given, capacitor must be solid tantalum. 25µF aluminum electrolytic may be substituted.

†Required for stability. For value given, capacitor must be solid tantalum. 25µF aluminum electrolytic may be substituted. Values given may be increased without limit.

For output capacitance in excess of 100µF, a high current diode from input to output (1N4001, etc.) will protect the regulator from momentary input shorts.

Figure 2. Fixed Regulator



Please be aware that an important notice concerning availability, standard warranty, and use in critical applications of Texas Instruments semiconductor products and disclaimers thereto appears at the end of this data sheet.

All trademarks are the property of their respective owners.

PRODUCTION DATA information is current as of publication date. Products conform to specifications per the terms of the Texas Instruments standard warranty. Production processing does not necessarily include testing of all parameters.

Copyright © 1999–2013, Texas Instruments Incorporated



These devices have limited built-in ESD protection. The leads should be shorted together or the device placed in conductive foam during storage or handling to prevent electrostatic damage to the MOS gates.

ABSOLUTE MAXIMUM RATINGS⁽¹⁾

Input Voltage	
($V_o = -5V$)	-25V
($V_o = -12V$ and $-15V$)	-35V
Input-Output Differential	
($V_o = -5V$)	25V
($V_o = -12V$ and $-15V$)	30V
Power Dissipation ⁽²⁾	Internally Limited
Operating Junction Temperature Range	0°C to +125°C
Storage Temperature Range	-65°C to +150°C
Lead Temperature (Soldering, 10 sec.)	230°C

- (1) Absolute Maximum Ratings indicate limits beyond which damage to the device may occur. Operating Ratings indicate conditions for which the device is intended to be functional, but do not ensure Specific Performance limits. For ensured specifications and test conditions, see the Electrical Characteristics.
- (2) Refer to [DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS](#) for details.

ELECTRICAL CHARACTERISTICS

Conditions unless otherwise noted: $I_{OUT} = 500mA$, $C_{IN} = 2.2\mu F$, $C_{OUT} = 1\mu F$, 0°C ≤ T_J ≤ +125°C, Power Dissipation ≤ 1.5W.

Part Number			LM7905C			Units
Output Voltage			-5V			
Input Voltage (unless otherwise specified)			-10V			
Symbol	Parameter	Conditions	Min	Typ	Max	
V _O	Output Voltage	T _J = 25°C	-4.8	-5.0	-5.2	V
		5mA ≤ I _{OUT} ≤ 1A, P ≤ 15W	-4.75		-5.25	V
				(-20 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -7)	V	
ΔV _O	Line Regulation	T _J = 25°C, ⁽¹⁾		8	50	mV
				(-25 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -7)		V
				2	15	mV
				(-12 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -8)		V
ΔV _O	Load Regulation	T _J = 25°C, ⁽¹⁾ 5mA ≤ I _{OUT} ≤ 1.5A 250mA ≤ I _{OUT} ≤ 750mA		15	100	mV
				5	50	mV
I _Q	Quiescent Current	T _J = 25°C		1	2	mA
ΔI _Q	Quiescent Current Change	With Line	0.5			mA
			(-25 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -7)			V
		With Load, 5mA ≤ I _{OUT} ≤ 1A	0.5			mA
V _n	Output Noise Voltage Ripple Rejection	T _A = 25°C, 10Hz ≤ f ≤ 100Hz f = 120Hz	54	125		μV
				66		dB
				(-18 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -8)		V
		Dropout Voltage	T _J = 25°C, I _{OUT} = 1A		1.1	
I _{OMAX}	Peak Output Current	T _J = 25°C		2.2		A
	Average Temperature Coefficient of Output Voltage	I _{OUT} = 5mA, 0 C ≤ T _J ≤ 100°C		0.4		mV/°C

- (1) Regulation is measured at a constant junction temperature by pulse testing with a low duty cycle. Changes in output voltage due to heating effects must be taken into account.

ELECTRICAL CHARACTERISTICS

Conditions unless otherwise noted: $I_{OUT} = 500\text{mA}$, $C_{IN} = 2.2\mu\text{F}$, $C_{OUT} = 1\mu\text{F}$, $0^\circ\text{C} \leq T_J \leq +125^\circ\text{C}$, Power Dissipation $\leq 1.5\text{W}$.

Part Number			LM7912C			LM7915C			Units
Output Voltage			-12V			-15V			
Input Voltage (unless otherwise specified)			-19V			-23V			
Symbol	Parameter	Conditions	Min	Typ	Max	Min	Typ	Max	
V _O	Output Voltage	T _J = 25°C	-11.5	-12.0	-12.5	-14.4	-15.0	-15.6	V
		5mA ≤ I _{OUT} ≤ 1A,	-11.4		-12.6	-14.25		-15.75	V
		P ≤ 15W	(-27 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -14.5)			(-30 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -17.5)			V
ΔV _O	Line Regulation	T _J = 25°C, ⁽¹⁾	5 80			5 100			mV
			(-30 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -14.5)			(-30 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -17.5)			V
			3 30			3 50			mV
			(-22 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -16)			(-26 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -20)			V
ΔV _O	Load Regulation	T _J = 25°C, ⁽¹⁾							
		5mA ≤ I _{OUT} ≤ 1.5A		15	200		15	200	mV
		250mA ≤ I _{OUT} ≤ 750mA		5	75		5	75	mV
I _Q	Quiescent Current	T _J = 25°C		1.5	3		1.5	3	mA
ΔI _Q	Quiescent Current Change	With Line	0.5			0.5			mA
			(-30 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -14.5)			(-30 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -17.5)			V
		With Load, 5mA ≤ I _{OUT} ≤ 1A	0.5			0.5			mA
V _n	Output Noise Voltage	T _A = 25°C, 10Hz ≤ f ≤ 100Hz	300			375			μV
		f = 120 Hz	54	70		54	70		dB
	Ripple Rejection	T _J = 25°C, I _{OUT} = 1A	(-25 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -15)			(-30 ≤ V _{IN} ≤ -17.5)			V
			1.1			1.1			V
I _{OMAX}	Peak Output Current	T _J = 25°C		2.2			2.2		A
	Average Temperature Coefficient of Output Voltage	I _{OUT} = 5mA, 0 C ≤ T _J ≤ 100°C		-0.8			-1.0		mV/°C

(1) Regulation is measured at a constant junction temperature by pulse testing with a low duty cycle. Changes in output voltage due to heating effects must be taken into account.

DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

The LM79XX fixed voltage regulator series has thermal overload protection from excessive power dissipation, internal short circuit protection which limits the circuit's maximum current, and output transistor safe-area compensation for reducing the output current as the voltage across the pass transistor is increased.

Although the internal power dissipation is limited, the junction temperature must be kept below the maximum specified temperature (125°C) in order to meet data sheet specifications. To calculate the maximum junction temperature or heat sink required, the following thermal resistance values should be used:

Package	Typ θ_{JC} °C/W	Max θ_{JC} °C/W	Typ θ_{JA} °C/W	Max θ_{JA} °C/W
TO-220	3.0	5.0	60	40

$$P_{D\text{ MAX}} = \frac{T_{J\text{ MAX}} - T_A}{\theta_{JC} + \theta_{CA}} \text{ or } \frac{T_{J\text{ MAX}} - T_A}{\theta_{JA}}$$

$$\theta_{CA} = \theta_{CS} + \theta_{SA} \text{ (without heat sink)}$$

(1)

Solving for T_J :

$$T_J = T_A + P_D (\theta_{JC} + \theta_{CA})$$

or

$$= T_A + P_D \theta_{JA} \text{ (without heat sink)}$$

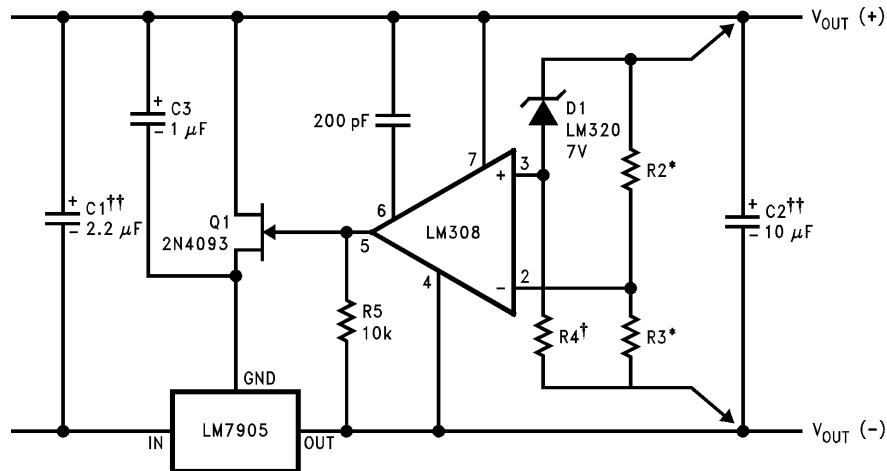
where

- T_J = Junction Temperature
- T_A = Ambient Temperature
- P_D = Power Dissipation
- θ_{JA} = Junction-to-Ambient Thermal Resistance
- θ_{JC} = Junction-to-Case Thermal Resistance
- θ_{CA} = Case-to-Ambient Thermal Resistance
- θ_{CS} = Case-to-Heat Sink Thermal Resistance
- θ_{SA} = Heat Sink-to-Ambient Thermal Resistance

Typical Applications

Bypass capacitors are necessary for stable operation of the LM79XX series of regulators over the input voltage and output current ranges. Output bypass capacitors will improve the transient response by the regulator.

The bypass capacitors, (2.2µF on the input, 1.0µF on the output) should be ceramic or solid tantalum which have good high frequency characteristics. If aluminum electrolytics are used, their values should be 10µF or larger. The bypass capacitors should be mounted with the shortest leads, and if possible, directly across the regulator terminals.



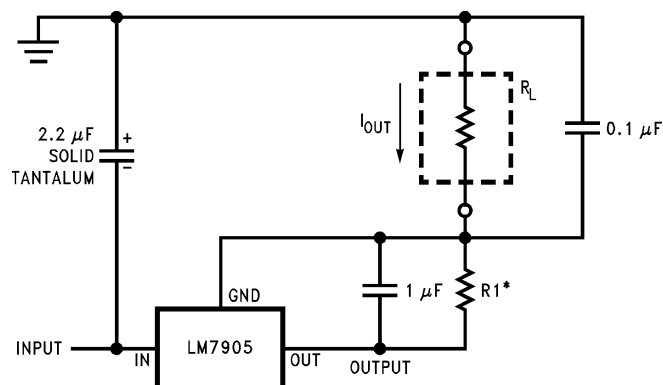
Load and line regulation < 0.01% temperature stability ≤ 0.2%

†Determine Zener current

††Solid tantalum

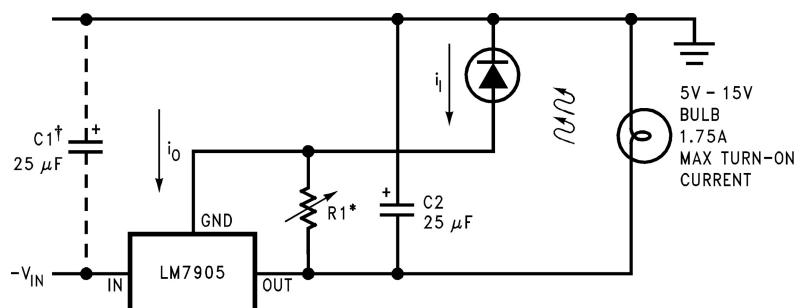
*Select resistors to set output voltage. 2 ppm/°C tracking suggested

Figure 3. High Stability 1 Amp Regulator



$$*I_{OUT} = 1 \text{ mA} + \frac{5V}{R1}$$

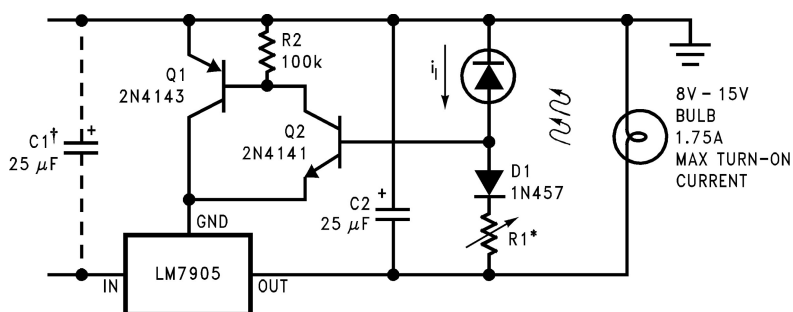
Figure 4. Current Source



*Lamp brightness increase until $i_l = i_Q (\approx 1 \text{ mA}) + 5V/R1$.

†Necessary only if raw supply filter capacitor is more that 2" from LM7905CT

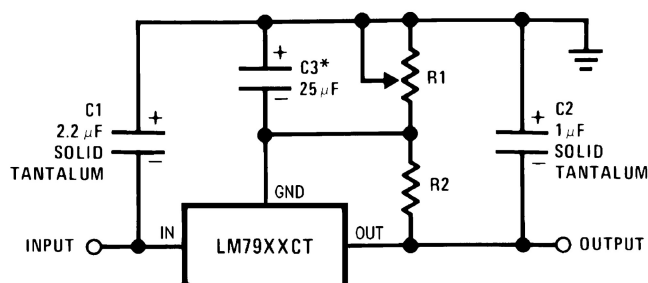
Figure 5. Light Controller Using Silicon Photo Cell



*Lamp brightness increases until $i_i = 5V/R1$ (i_i can be set as low as $1\mu A$)

†Necessary only if raw supply filter capacitor is more than 2" from LM7905

Figure 6. High-Sensitivity Light Controller



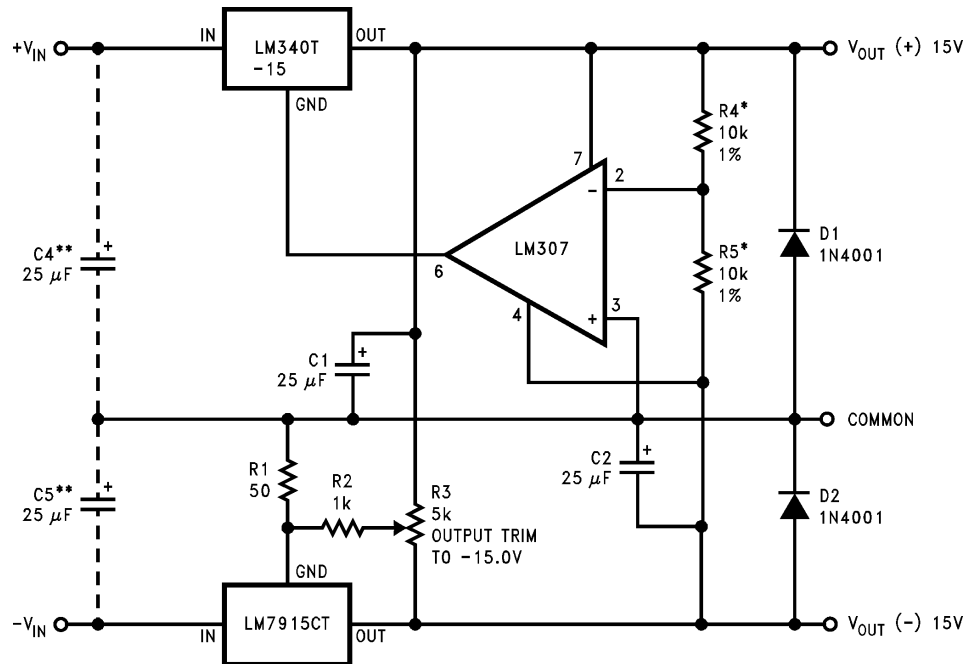
*Improves transient response and ripple rejection. Do not increase beyond $50\mu F$.

$$V_{OUT} = V_{SET} \left(\frac{R1 + R2}{R2} \right)$$

Select R2 as follows:

LM7905CT	300Ω
LM7912CT	750Ω
LM7915CT	1k

Figure 7. Variable Output



	(-15)	(+15)
Load Regulation at $\Delta I_L = 1A$	40mV	2mV
Output Ripple, $C_{IN} = 3000\mu F$, $I_L = 1A$	100 μVms	100 μVms
Temperature Stability	50mV	50mV
Output Noise 10Hz $\leq f \leq 10kHz$	150 μVms	150 μVms

*Resistor tolerance of R4 and R5 determine matching of (+) and (-) outputs.

**Necessary only if raw supply filter capacitors are more than 3" from regulators.

Figure 8. $\pm 15V$, 1 Amp Tracking Regulators

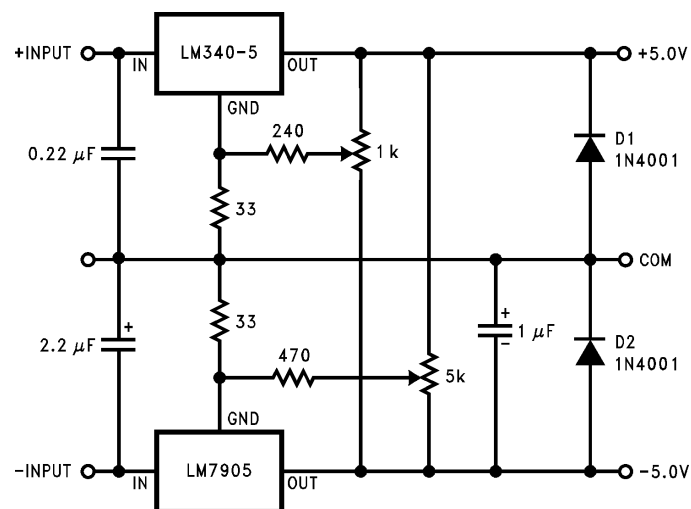


Figure 9. Dual Trimmed Supply

Schematic Diagrams

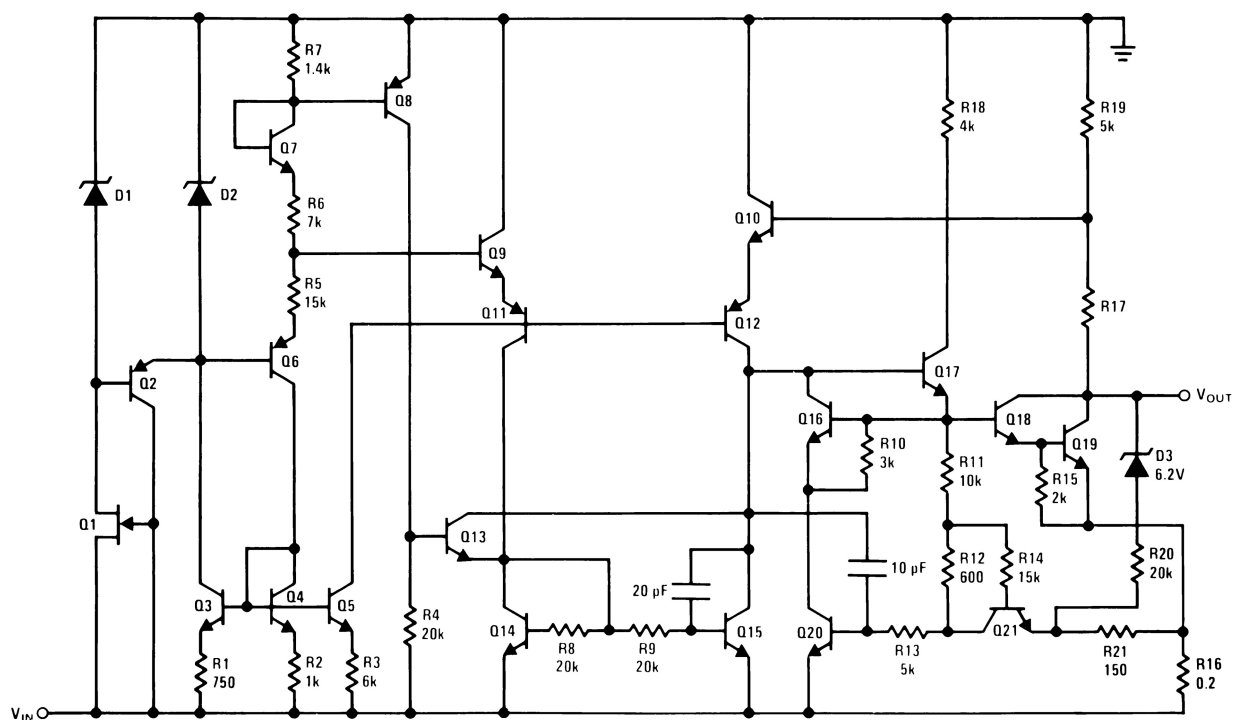


Figure 10. -5V

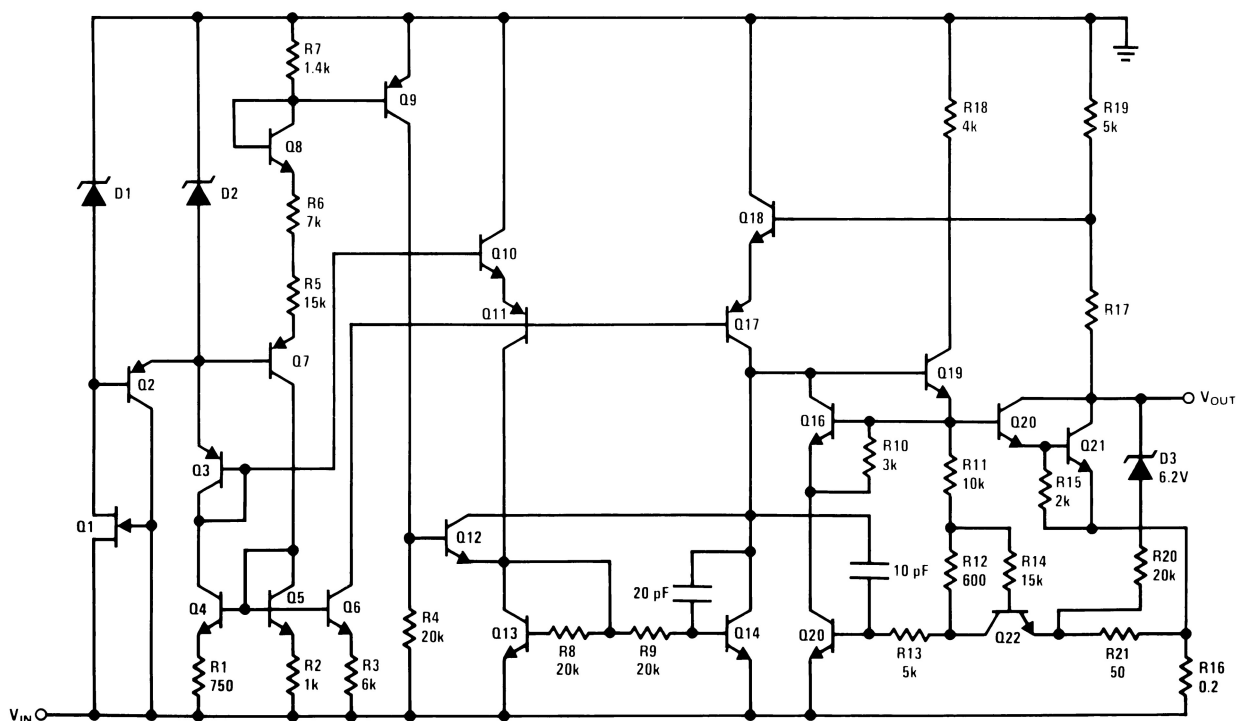


Figure 11. -12V and -15V

REVISION HISTORY

Changes from Revision B (May 2013) to Revision C	Page
• Changed layout of National Data Sheet to TI format.	8

PACKAGING INFORMATION

Orderable part number	Status (1)	Material type (2)	Package Pins	Package qty Carrier	RoHS (3)	Lead finish/ Ball material (4)	MSL rating/ Peak reflow (5)	Op temp (°C)	Part marking (6)
LM7905CT/NOPB	Active	Production	TO-220 (NDE) 3	45 TUBE	Yes	SN	Level-1-NA-UNLIM	0 to 125	LM7905CT
LM7905CT/NOPB.B	Active	Production	TO-220 (NDE) 3	45 TUBE	Yes	SN	Level-1-NA-UNLIM	0 to 125	LM7905CT
LM7912CT/NOPB	Active	Production	TO-220 (NDE) 3	45 TUBE	Yes	SN	Level-1-NA-UNLIM	0 to 125	LM7912CT
LM7912CT/NOPB.B	Active	Production	TO-220 (NDE) 3	45 TUBE	Yes	SN	Level-1-NA-UNLIM	0 to 125	LM7912CT
LM7915CT/NOPB	Active	Production	TO-220 (NDE) 3	45 TUBE	Yes	SN	Level-1-NA-UNLIM	0 to 125	LM7915CT
LM7915CT/NOPB.B	Active	Production	TO-220 (NDE) 3	45 TUBE	Yes	SN	Level-1-NA-UNLIM	0 to 125	LM7915CT

(1) **Status:** For more details on status, see our [product life cycle](#).

(2) **Material type:** When designated, preproduction parts are prototypes/experimental devices, and are not yet approved or released for full production. Testing and final process, including without limitation quality assurance, reliability performance testing, and/or process qualification, may not yet be complete, and this item is subject to further changes or possible discontinuation. If available for ordering, purchases will be subject to an additional waiver at checkout, and are intended for early internal evaluation purposes only. These items are sold without warranties of any kind.

(3) **RoHS values:** Yes, No, RoHS Exempt. See the [TI RoHS Statement](#) for additional information and value definition.

(4) **Lead finish/Ball material:** Parts may have multiple material finish options. Finish options are separated by a vertical ruled line. Lead finish/Ball material values may wrap to two lines if the finish value exceeds the maximum column width.

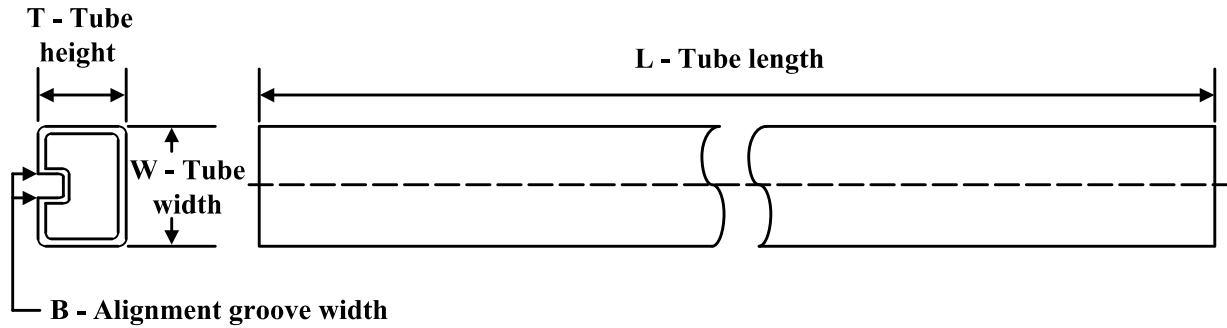
(5) **MSL rating/Peak reflow:** The moisture sensitivity level ratings and peak solder (reflow) temperatures. In the event that a part has multiple moisture sensitivity ratings, only the lowest level per JEDEC standards is shown. Refer to the shipping label for the actual reflow temperature that will be used to mount the part to the printed circuit board.

(6) **Part marking:** There may be an additional marking, which relates to the logo, the lot trace code information, or the environmental category of the part.

Multiple part markings will be inside parentheses. Only one part marking contained in parentheses and separated by a "-" will appear on a part. If a line is indented then it is a continuation of the previous line and the two combined represent the entire part marking for that device.

Important Information and Disclaimer: The information provided on this page represents TI's knowledge and belief as of the date that it is provided. TI bases its knowledge and belief on information provided by third parties, and makes no representation or warranty as to the accuracy of such information. Efforts are underway to better integrate information from third parties. TI has taken and continues to take reasonable steps to provide representative and accurate information but may not have conducted destructive testing or chemical analysis on incoming materials and chemicals. TI and TI suppliers consider certain information to be proprietary, and thus CAS numbers and other limited information may not be available for release.

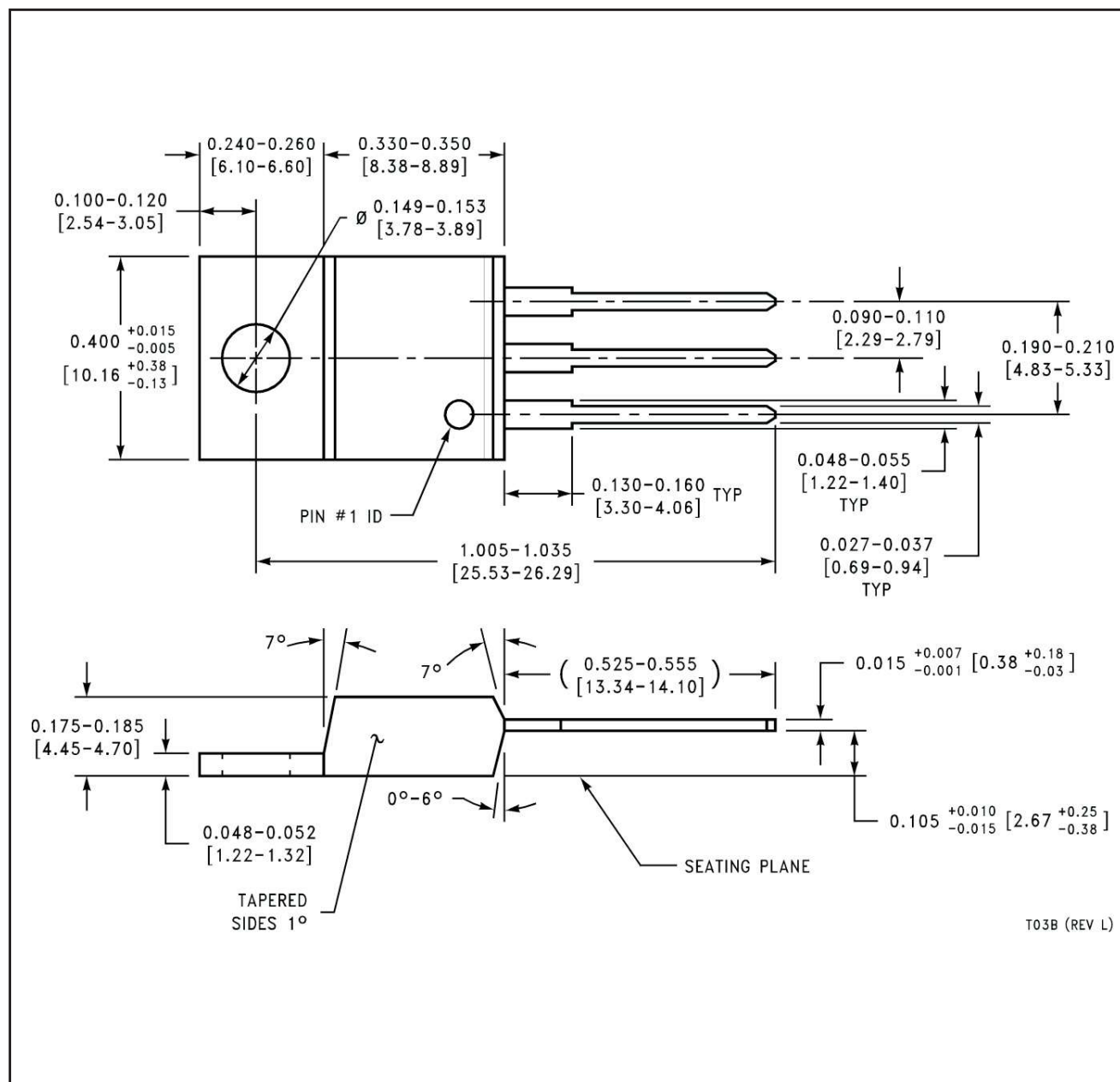
In no event shall TI's liability arising out of such information exceed the total purchase price of the TI part(s) at issue in this document sold by TI to Customer on an annual basis.

TUBE


*All dimensions are nominal

Device	Package Name	Package Type	Pins	SPQ	L (mm)	W (mm)	T (μm)	B (mm)
LM7905CT/NOPB	NDE	TO-220	3	45	502	33	6985	4.06
LM7905CT/NOPB.B	NDE	TO-220	3	45	502	33	6985	4.06
LM7912CT/NOPB	NDE	TO-220	3	45	502	33	6985	4.06
LM7912CT/NOPB.B	NDE	TO-220	3	45	502	33	6985	4.06
LM7915CT/NOPB	NDE	TO-220	3	45	502	33	6985	4.06
LM7915CT/NOPB.B	NDE	TO-220	3	45	502	33	6985	4.06

NDE0003B



IMPORTANT NOTICE AND DISCLAIMER

TI PROVIDES TECHNICAL AND RELIABILITY DATA (INCLUDING DATASHEETS), DESIGN RESOURCES (INCLUDING REFERENCE DESIGNS), APPLICATION OR OTHER DESIGN ADVICE, WEB TOOLS, SAFETY INFORMATION, AND OTHER RESOURCES "AS IS" AND WITH ALL FAULTS, AND DISCLAIMS ALL WARRANTIES, EXPRESS AND IMPLIED, INCLUDING WITHOUT LIMITATION ANY IMPLIED WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY, FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE OR NON-INFRINGEMENT OF THIRD PARTY INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY RIGHTS.

These resources are intended for skilled developers designing with TI products. You are solely responsible for (1) selecting the appropriate TI products for your application, (2) designing, validating and testing your application, and (3) ensuring your application meets applicable standards, and any other safety, security, regulatory or other requirements.

These resources are subject to change without notice. TI grants you permission to use these resources only for development of an application that uses the TI products described in the resource. Other reproduction and display of these resources is prohibited. No license is granted to any other TI intellectual property right or to any third party intellectual property right. TI disclaims responsibility for, and you fully indemnify TI and its representatives against any claims, damages, costs, losses, and liabilities arising out of your use of these resources.

TI's products are provided subject to [TI's Terms of Sale](#), [TI's General Quality Guidelines](#), or other applicable terms available either on [ti.com](#) or provided in conjunction with such TI products. TI's provision of these resources does not expand or otherwise alter TI's applicable warranties or warranty disclaimers for TI products. Unless TI explicitly designates a product as custom or customer-specified, TI products are standard, catalog, general purpose devices.

TI objects to and rejects any additional or different terms you may propose.

Copyright © 2026, Texas Instruments Incorporated

Last updated 10/2025